

# Introduction to “Reflection” as a tool for Critical Thinking

## *Experiential Learning*



# Who am I?

- Industrial Engineer by trade and training (ND:Ind Eng 2011, BTech:Ind Eng 2013)
- Worked in FMCG Industry for about 5 years before I decided to pursue my Masters studies.
- Now I teach Work preparedness and mentor future leaders in my field.
- I am also a Certified L2 CrossFit trainer.
- I love to see and guide people through these learning moments
- I.E'S are concerned about how things work and how to make systems better (Continuously improving)
- Fascinated with the design aspects and art of creation, and the mind.



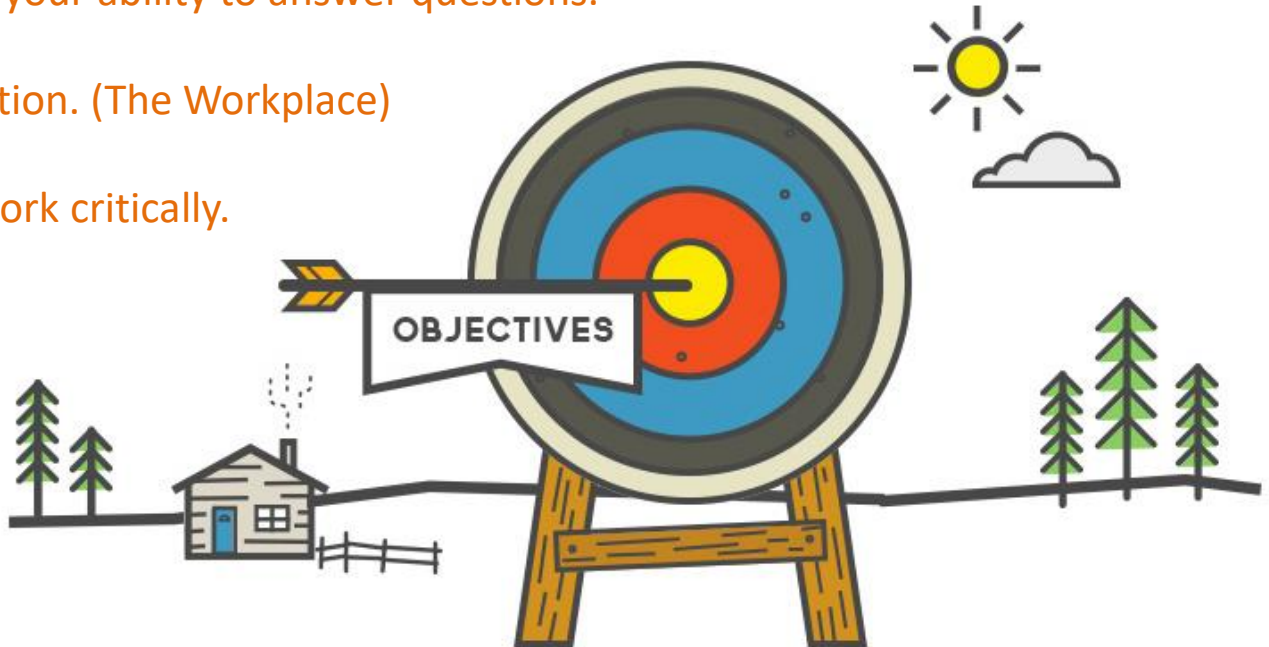
# Agenda

- What is Reflection
- Why is it useful for Critical Thinking
- The Logbook
- Prepare you for the workplace.
- Reflection on Learning activity



# My Goals

- Make you think and challenge your world view
- Understand the value of Reflection.
- Understanding the importance of planning and Logging your tasks.
- Improve the clarity of your thoughts and your ability to answer questions.
- Understand how to prepare for any situation. (The Workplace)
- Assess your own and other's quality of work critically.





KEANU REEVES LAURENCE FISHBURNE

T H E  
MATRIX



# What is Thinking?

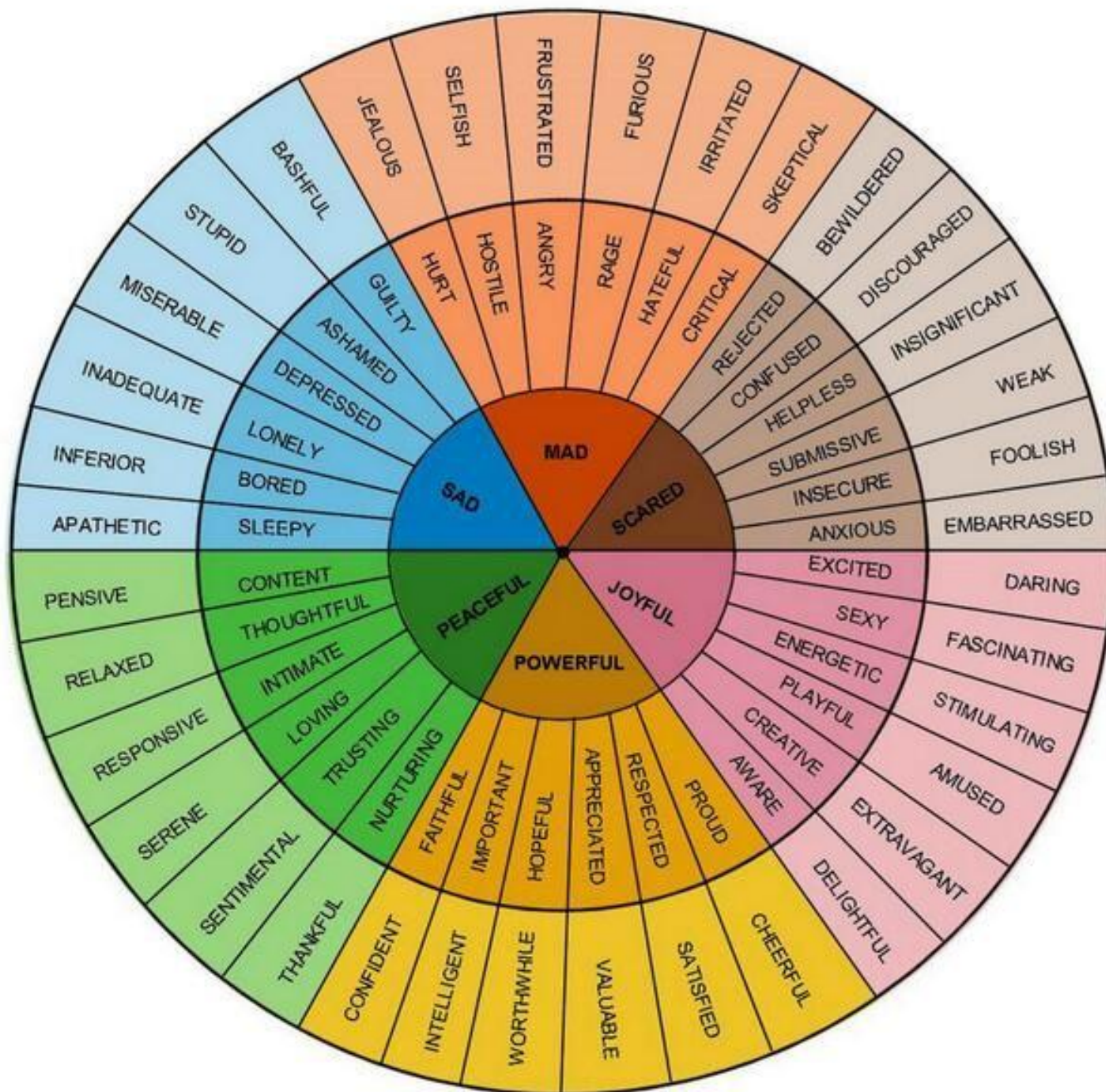
- What are thoughts?
  - What does it mean to “Think Clearly”?
  - Does Thinking Clearly = Thinking Critically?
  - Critical is not the same as Criticism.
  - Is “Thinking Deeply” on a topic the same as having a great understanding of the Topic?
  - **“Your life is always moving in the Direction of your strongest thought”**
- 



# What is Reflection

REFLECTION IS SIMPLY THOUGHTS, PUT INTO A WRITTEN FORM, THAT IS UNDERSTOOD BY OTHERS.

- A decoding of the signals being sent to your brain
- Depends on the complexity or the simplicity of the event or occurrence.
- The Movie in my Mind.
- You may have been asked in the past to critically assess...





# ...Continued

## EVALUATING (REFLECTING ON) THE ...

- After the event (Presentation), reflect on your own performance.
- Think about what worked and what was most effective.
- Ask classmates what they thought of the presentation.
- Make notes as a reminder for future.
- Do not criticise yourself during the process



# The LOGBOOK

WEEKLY REPORTING ON THE TASKS YOU PERFORMED.

Reflection is always performed in the past tense:

- Write down what you have done only after you've done it or before you go to bed
- At the end of every day plan a time where your calendar blocks out time for reflection.
- Don't spend more than 10-15 min for this as more is not sustainable
- Make it a daily ritual.

**Faculty of informatics & Design, Department of Information Technology: SUMMARY OF WIL/IE EXPERIENCE**

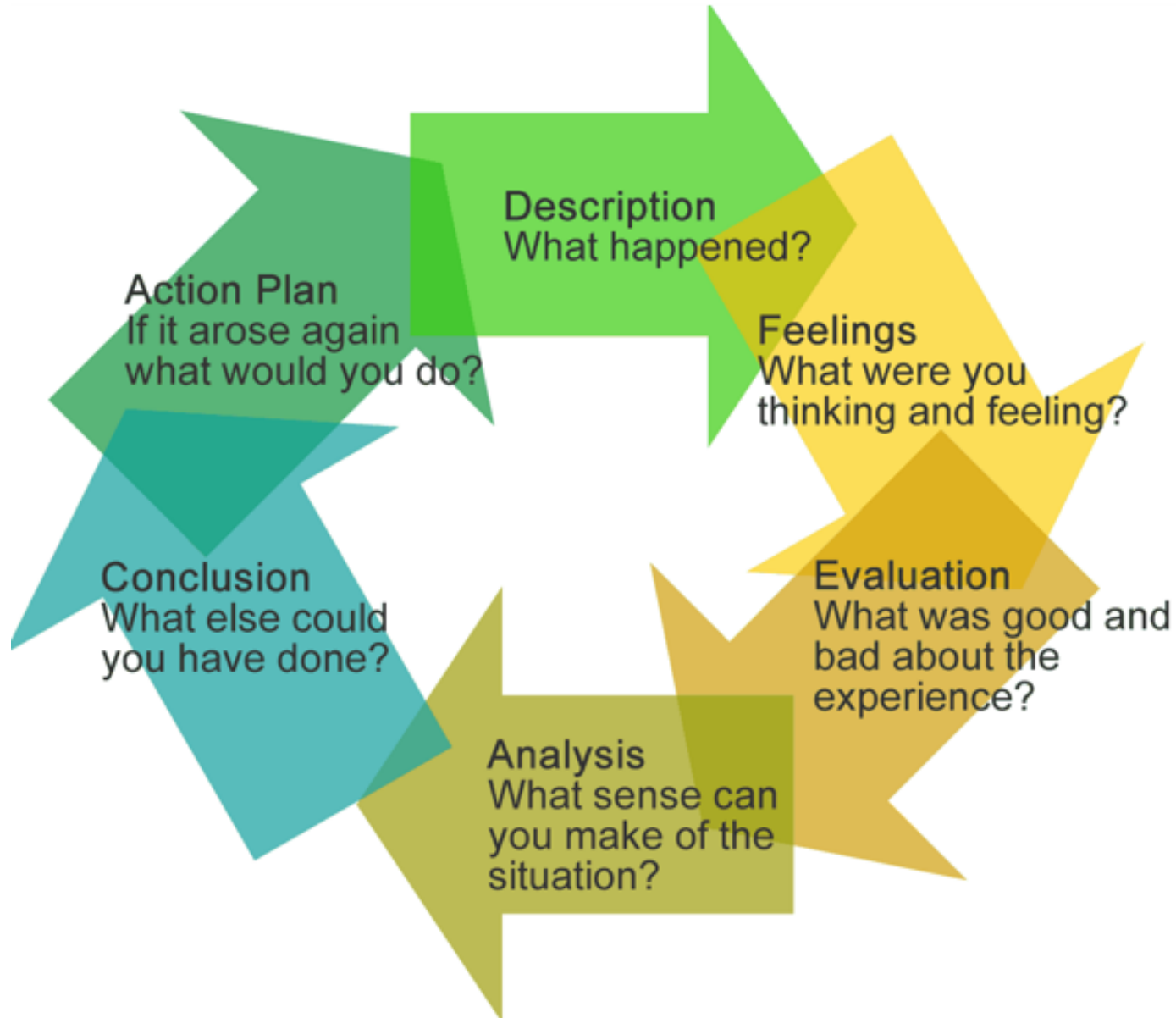
| Day                                                                         | Co-coordinator's Signature |                                  | Description of Tasks Performed For Period: |  | TO                           |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------|--|
| Mon                                                                         |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Tues                                                                        |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Wed                                                                         |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Thurs                                                                       |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Fri                                                                         |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Students working over weekends are to include such activity in this section |                            |                                  |                                            |  |                              |  |
| <b>Performance Appraisal (1-5)</b>                                          |                            | <b>key</b>                       | <b>Comments from Mentor</b>                |  | <b>Comments from Student</b> |  |
| Portrayal of Skills, Knowledge                                              |                            | 1 - More development required    |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Quality of Work, Attention to detail                                        |                            | 2 - able to but not consistent   |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Delivering according to spec                                                |                            | 3 - marginal                     |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Demonstration of Responsibility                                             |                            | 4 - competent                    |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Motivation for tasks                                                        |                            | 5 - performs beyond expectations |                                            |  |                              |  |
| Communication                                                               |                            | <b>Signed</b>                    |                                            |  |                              |  |
|                                                                             |                            | <b>Date</b>                      |                                            |  | <b>Signed</b>                |  |

**Faculty of informatics & Design, Department of Information Technology: SUMMARY OF WIL/IE EXPERIENCE**

| Day                                                                         | Co-coordinator's Signature | Description of Tasks Performed For Period:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 29 April 2019        | TO                                            | 3 May 2019 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------|
| Mon                                                                         |                            | Today I planned on tackling the problem ... I had initially thought that it could be solved quickly by doing...<br>However this turned out to be a <b>disastrous</b> experience because everything crashed and I lost important Operating information. I felt <b>frustrated</b> because I spent 6 hours working on this project.<br>I also <b>felt stupid</b> for not backing up the servers regularly. This has forced me to change my work patterns and learn to ...<br>My plan of action going forward is to ... |                      |                                               |            |
| Tues                                                                        |                            | What did you do today?<br>Was it good / Bad?<br>What sense can you make of this situation?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                      |                                               |            |
| Wed                                                                         |                            | PUBLIC HOLIDAY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                      |                                               |            |
| Thurs                                                                       |                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                      |                                               |            |
| Fri                                                                         |                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                      |                                               |            |
| Students working over weekends are to include such activity in this section |                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                      |                                               |            |
| Performance Appraisal (1-5)                                                 |                            | key                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Comments from Mentor | Comments from Student                         |            |
| Portrayal of Skills, Knowledge                                              |                            | 1 - <b>more</b> development required                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                      | Reflect on your Learning that has taken place |            |
| Quality of Work, Attention to detail                                        |                            | 2 - able to but not consistent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                      | 60% work <b>40%</b> (Emotions / "The Feels")  |            |
| Delivering according to spec                                                |                            | 3 - marginal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                      |                                               |            |
| Demonstration of Responsibility                                             |                            | 4 - competent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                      |                                               |            |
| Motivation for tasks                                                        |                            | 5 - performs beyond expectations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                      |                                               |            |
| Communication                                                               |                            | Signed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                      | Signed                                        |            |
|                                                                             |                            | Date                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                      |                                               |            |



# Reflection Activity



# Transfer of Knowledge into the Workplace

- Bridging the gap between what is learnt in class and what actually happens in the workplace.
- The knowledge at university and work are of different types.
- You need to apply the contextual (theory) knowledge to the conceptual (practical) knowledge.
- Workplace problems are solved by drawing from various subjects.
- Working to Learn, Learning to Work – Be humble, Ask Questions

# WIL within a Company

YOU ARE NOW PRODUCING FOR A REAL CUSTOMER AND THE HEAT IS ON...

You need to:

- be actively involved in the workplace and not just observe others doing the work.
- learn and execute tasks - get involved in the actual practices.
- handle pressure and deadlines.
- act professionally.
- think on your feet and think independently. Be innovative.
- be mindful of set specifications to assure the best possible quality of product/service.
- learn to obey demands from superiors and understand the dynamics of being a subordinate.
- learn, participate, record and observe all aspects including the input and the output areas.
- investigate the problem and write up a technical report.
- learn people skills and tactful ways to approach people.
- learn to work with the different personalities around you.
- do a thorough situational analysis.
- be patient. Finding a solution does not happen overnight.



DEVELOPING A **GROWTH MINDSET**



**INSTEAD OF.....**

**TRY THINKING....**

I'm not good at this

What am I missing?

I give up

I'll use a different strategy

It's good enough

Is this really my best work?

I can't make this any better

I can always improve

This is too hard

This may take some time

I made a mistake

Mistakes help me to learn

I just can't do this

I am going to train my brain

I'll never be that smart

I will learn how to do this

Plan A didn't work

There's always Plan B

My friend can do it

I will learn from them



# In Summary

- Thinking is Reflection – we can all think, therefore we can practice Reflection.
- Be aware of what you are thinking about.
- Set apart time daily to reflect on the days Learning events.
- We are all here to learn and grow – Be truthful and kind.
- Ask questions first, then listen to the answer.
- Mindset beats Skillset everyday of the week.



WAKE UP  
KICK ASS  
HAVE FUN  
REPEAT

# Future communication

Communication is vital, please stay in touch with your co-ordinator:

## JUNIOR LECTURER

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If you enjoyed today or hated it, even if you didn't learn anything new please tell me about it. I'd love to hear your feedback so that I can improve and get better. Thanks  
Please email me or follow the link and fill out the Google form